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THE CONVERSATION THAT began in the snow-capped Swiss Alps reached a crescendo in the desert metropolis of Dubai. From the World Economic Forum (WEF) in Davos to the World Governments Summit (WGS) in Dubai, one theme dominated every panel, every discussion, every conversation: artificial intelligence (AI) wasn't just coming, it was here and the world was scrambling to understand what that meant.

At the World Governments Summit 2026, the urgency was palpable. This was no longer a speculative debate about the fu-

ture. Real companies were seeing real disruption, markets were reacting with real panic and leaders were grappling with real questions about sovereignty, jobs and the future of human work itself.

MARKETS BLINK FIRST

The market's wake-up call came swiftly and brutally. When Anthropic unveiled its AI assistant Claude with new plug-ins for legal services, global equity markets trembled. Indian IT stocks crashed, with the Nifty IT index plunging over 7% in a single day. In the US, nearly \$300 billion in market value vanished from software and financial data companies.